



The AI Banking Institute
Turning Bankers into Builders

ROLE PLAYBOOK · EXECUTIVE / LEADERSHIP · V1.0

The Executive / Leadership AI-Native Playbook

Set the AI direction, approve the guardrails, and report adoption with evidence. This playbook helps leadership move from scattered pilots to a governed AI program.

The operating principle

Leadership does not need to pick every tool. Leadership must name the outcomes, approve the guardrails, and require evidence before scale.

AI adoption inside a financial institution becomes risky when the strategy is implicit. Teams experiment, vendors pitch, staff improvise, and the board receives anecdotes instead of a controlled view of progress. The executive role is to turn AI from a collection of experiments into an operating program with ownership, boundaries, metrics, and review cadence.

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Executive AI direction map

DIMENSION	LEADERSHIP DECISION
Primary goal	Governed ROI
Core artifact	AI adoption thesis
Risk focus	Strategy, oversight, data boundaries, and board visibility
Recommended path	Maturity Assessment → Adoption Thesis → Governance Guardrails → Quarterly Review

Where leadership can use AiBI immediately

Write a one-page adoption thesis

State where AI earns its keep this year, who owns it, and what "good" looks like.

Artifact: AI adoption thesis.

Set the guardrails

Approve the data-safety, review, and approved-tool rules before staff improvise their own.

Artifact: AI use guardrails.

Brief the board

Turn pilot results into a plain-English board update with risk posture and next decisions.

Artifact: Board AI briefing.

Pressure-test a vendor pitch

Score an AI vendor claim against your data, controls, retention, and exit risk before signing.

Artifact: Vendor evaluation notes.

The risk line

Executive AI work is usually low-risk when it frames direction, compares options, or prepares internal discussion. It becomes higher risk when it approves a vendor, sets customer-facing policy, affects staffing, or reports operational return without evidence. Treat those outputs as board-ready only after documented human review.

From scattered pilots to a governed program

1. **Frame.** Name the one or two outcomes AI should move this year and the single accountable owner.
Artifact: Adoption thesis.
2. **Guardrail.** Approve the data-safety tiers, the human-review rule, and the approved-tool list as policy.
Artifact: Signed guardrails.
3. **Measure.** Pick two metrics - time saved and correction rate - and require them on every pilot. Artifact: Pilot scorecard.
4. **Review.** Run a quarterly review: what scaled, what stopped, where the risk now sits. Artifact: Quarterly AI review.

Executive checklist

- ❑ One accountable owner named for AI adoption.
- ❑ Data-safety and human-review rules approved as policy.
- ❑ Approved-tool list published to all staff.
- ❑ Every pilot reports time saved and correction rate.
- ❑ Board has seen the current risk posture.
- ❑ A decision to scale or stop is made on evidence, not vibes.

Toolbox artifacts

ARTIFACT	USE IT FOR	STATUS
AI Adoption Thesis Template	Define the institution's first AI direction and owner.	Ready
AI Use Guardrails One-Pager	Publish the rules staff can actually follow.	Ready
Board AI Briefing Template	Report progress, controls, and next decisions.	Ready
Pilot Scorecard	Track time saved, correction rate, and scale/stop decision.	Ready
Vendor Evaluation Reference Card	Check data, controls, retention, and exit risk.	Draft

30-day leadership path

1. Week 1: Pick the accountable AI owner and one business outcome.
2. Week 2: Approve the safe-use guardrails and publish the approved-tool path.
3. Week 3: Require every active pilot to submit the same two metrics.
4. Week 4: Run a leadership review and choose which pilot scales, pauses, or stops.

SOURCE BASIS

Built from the AiBI readiness assessment, NIST AI Risk Management Framework, Interagency Guidance on Third-Party Risk Management, and AIEOG AI Lexicon concepts for AI governance, AI use-case inventory, and human-in-the-loop review. Adapt before adoption.